

# English Writing (II)

Department of Foreign Languages and Literature  
National Sun Yat-sen University

114-2 (2026 Winter)

- **Meet your instructor**

**Chia-Wen Lo (羅佳雯)**

Office: 文 5039

E-mail: chiawenl[AT]mail.nsysu.edu.tw

Office hours: Weds. 13:00-15:00 and Thurs. 13:00-15:00, or by appointment

- **Course description**

This course builds on students' prior training in English writing and focuses on exposition, argumentation, and rhetorical strategies. Students will learn how explanation supports persuasion, how arguments are constructed and evaluated, and how rhetorical choices shape meaning. Emphasis is placed on analytical thinking, clarity of reasoning, and rhetorical awareness rather than grammatical accuracy alone. Note: Some content is subject to change.

- **Learning Objectives**

By the end of this course, students will be able to:

1. Write clear and reader-oriented exposition
2. Construct and evaluate arguments using analysis, description, narrative, and definition
3. Identify unsound arguments and common logical fallacies
4. Use rhetorical strategies (e.g. metaphor, arrangement, stylization) effectively
5. Respond analytically to texts, media, and peer writing
6. Reflect on patterns in their own writing using journal-based data

- **Teaching Methods**

1. Lectures and guided discussions
2. In-class writing practice

- **Attendance, Academic Integrity and Responsible AI Use**

Regular attendance and active participation are expected, as much of the learning in this course takes place through in-class activities and discussion. Students are responsible for completing their own work and submitting assignments on time. Being late for **more than ten minutes** to class will constitute an absence. Only

absences such as illness, official commitments, or emergencies will be authorized, and these absences necessitate supporting documentation (e.g., medical certificates, official correspondence) to secure the instructor's approval. Any anticipated absence must be communicated in advance.

Academic honesty is essential to meaningful learning. All submitted work must represent your own thinking and understanding. Plagiarism—including copying from published sources, online materials, classmates, or submitting work generated by others as your own—is not permitted. Any confirmed case of plagiarism or ghostwriting will result in a score of zero for the assignment. Please turn in your assignment on time. Late assignments will NOT be accepted.

The use of AI tools (e.g., ChatGPT, Grammarly, translation tools) is allowed only as a learning aid, such as for brainstorming ideas, clarifying concepts, or improving language clarity. However, AI tools may not be used to generate full assignments, quizzes, or written responses unless explicitly permitted by the instructor. Any use of AI must be transparent and properly acknowledged when relevant. Students are responsible for ensuring that all submitted work reflects their own comprehension and meets the academic standards of the course.

- **Your perspective matters!**

Please keep in mind that the readings, lectures, and comments from the instructors will reflect a particular point of view. These perspectives may not be the same as yours! If you find that you disagree with the ideas in the readings and lectures or the perspectives of your colleagues in the course, please express yourself!! A significant part of a college education is learning about the complexity of various issues. Therefore, it is important that we listen and respect one another but we do not have to agree. A richer discussion will occur when a variety of perspectives are presented in class.

- **Student Well-being**

Students may experience stressors that can impact both their academic experience and their personal well-being. These may include academic pressure and challenges associated with relationships, physical health, mental health, alcohol or other drugs, identities, finances, etc. If you are experiencing concerns, **seeking help is a best thing to do for yourself and those who care about you**. If the source of your stressors is academic, please contact me so that we can find solutions together. For personal concerns, you can also find the resources on the department website.

- **Accommodations**

If you think you need an accommodation for a disability, please let me know at your earliest convenience. Many aspects of this course, the assignments, the in-class activities, and the way the course is usually taught may be modified to facilitate your participation and progress. As soon as you make me aware of your needs, we can work with the Office of Services for Students with Disabilities (SSD) to help determine appropriate academic accommodations.

- **Required Materials**

Weekly assigned readings will be posted on the course website (Canvas). The course material is provided for educational purposes only and is accessible only to students enrolled in this course. No textbook purchase is required. Below are the reference books we will use a lot. You can find them here: <https://open.umn.edu/opentextbooks/>

Carol Lynn Moder, Alys Avalos-Rivera, Ho'omana Nathan Horton, Miriam Kinfé, Paul Sims, Seth French, and Yelin Zhao. (2020). *University Academic Writing for International Students: A Usage-based Approach*.

Oklahoma State University, USA.

Kelli Hallsten-Erickson, and Amy Jo Swing. (2025). *You, Writing! A Guide to College Composition - 3rd Edition*. Minnesota State Colleges and Universities, USA.

Unnamed Authors. (2015). *Writing for Success*. University of Minnesota Libraries Publishing, USA.

- **Evaluations**

| Category                            | Percentage | Description                                                                                             |
|-------------------------------------|------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Weekly Journals & Peer Responses    | 24%        | 1. One 250-word journal entry per week in the Discussions.<br>2. Two analytical peer responses required |
| Participation & In-class Activities | 16%        | –                                                                                                       |
| Essay Outline                       | 5%         | Mid-term and final outlines                                                                             |
| Essay Drafts                        | 5%         | Mid-term and final drafts                                                                               |
| Peer-review                         | 10%        | Mid-term and final                                                                                      |
| Revisions                           | 10%        | Mid-term and final                                                                                      |
| Mid-term Essay (Finalized Output)   | 15%        | 550 words, 4–5 paragraphs                                                                               |
| Final Essay (Finalized Output)      | 15%        | 550 words, 4–5 paragraphs                                                                               |

- **Schedule (subject to change)**

| Week       | Topic/Focus                                      | Assignments/Activities                                                             |
|------------|--------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 (Feb 25) | Course Introduction<br>& The Power of Definition | Syllabus Review;<br>Week 1 journal                                                 |
| 2 (Mar 4)  | The Structure of Argumentation                   | Week 2 journal<br>Peer Responses to Week 1 Journal<br>Mid-term essay – Outline     |
| 3 (Mar 11) | NO CLASS (全校運動會)                                 | Peer Responses to Week 2 Journal                                                   |
| 4 (Mar 18) | From Exposition to Persuasion                    | Week 4 journal<br>Mid-term essay – Draft                                           |
| 5 (Mar 25) | Analytical & Reflective Response                 | Week 5 journal<br>Peer Responses to Week 4 Journal<br>Mid-term essay – Peer Review |
| 6 (Apr 1)  | Arguing through Description                      | Week 6 journal<br>Peer Responses to Week 5 Journal<br>Mid-term essay – Revision    |

|             |                                                           |                                                                                   |
|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 7 (Apr 8)   | Arguing through Analysis                                  | Week 7 journal<br>Peer Responses to Week 6 Journal                                |
| 8 (Apr 15)  | <b>Mid-term Consultation Week</b>                         | Peer Responses to Week 7 Journal<br>Mid-term Essay – Finalized Output             |
| 9 (Apr 22)  | Arguing through Narrative                                 | Week 9 journal                                                                    |
| 10 (Apr 29) | Unsound Arguments (I):<br>Assumptions & Arbitrariness     | Week 10 journal<br>Peer Responses to Week 9 Journal<br>Final essay – Outline      |
| 11 (May 6)  | Unsound Arguments (II):<br>Specific Fallacies             | Week 11 journal<br>Peer Responses to Week 10 Journal                              |
| 12 (May 13) | Rhetorical Strategies (I):<br>Imagery & Figures of Speech | Week 12 journal<br>Peer Responses to Week 11 Journal<br>Final essay – Draft       |
| 13 (May 20) | Rhetorical Strategies (II):<br>Arrangement & Flow         | Week 13 journal<br>Peer Responses to Week 12 Journal<br>Final essay – Peer Review |
| 14 (May 27) | Revisiting Writing Basics                                 | Week 14 journal<br>Peer Responses to Week 13 Journal<br>Final essay – Revision    |
| 15 (Jun 3)  | Stylization & Voice                                       | Week 15 journal<br>Peer Responses to Week 14 Journal                              |
| 16 (Jun 10) | Reflection & Final Essay Due                              | Final Essay – Finalized Output                                                    |